JAYA HARSHA THIPPANA

Principal Data Scientist · AI & Data Science Executive

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PROFILE

I turn visual AI research into revenue. I own both R&D and Data Science at Vizit, the visual intelligence platform the world's largest consumer brands use to win on the digital shelf. The company's core intellectual property is my work: proprietary Visual AI trained on real commerce outcomes rather than proxies for appeal, fusing product imagery with search behavior, market movement, and conversion signals across thousands of categories, with derived signals running into the trillions. Everything from zero-to-one research through what ships in production runs through my team, and I serve as the final check on whether our methods hold up to scrutiny, including defending them directly with enterprise customers. What I've learned over the years is that models don't create value by being accurate. They create value by being trusted enough to act on. So I hold my work to two bars: science that survives scrutiny, and translation clear enough that an executive will put money behind it. Most teams pick one. We do both.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Built Vizit's core IP** — the proprietary Visual AI model stack behind every product the company sells; the foundational asset of the business.
- **$50M+ in career revenue and savings impact** — $35M annualized revenue (Harley-Davidson), $15M+ annual savings (Northwestern Mutual), $800K–$900K infrastructure savings and ~$500K TCV protected (Vizit).
- **Own the technology and future product vision** — report directly to the CEO, set where Vizit's Visual AI goes next, and lead a team of 5 data scientists to deliver it.
- **Built two data science functions from zero** — first data scientist at Harley-Davidson and architect of Vizit's DS organization, spanning hiring, standards, and executive reporting.
- **Trusted with the science in front of customers** — 60 causal-inference impact studies delivered to the world's largest consumer brands, presented and defended directly by me.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Data Scientist

Mar 2026 – Present

Vizit · Boston, MA

- Report directly to the CEO. Own both R&D and Data Science with a team of **5 data scientists** spanning production ML, customer analytics, and research — the company's core IP from zero-to-one research through production.
- Directing a complete rebuild of the core Visual AI platform — the foundation of every Vizit product — delivering **$800K–$900K in infrastructure cost savings** through architecture changes and optimization, alongside gains in reliability and scale.
- Own the technology and future product vision with the executive team: where the technology goes next, how it reaches customers through product and engineering, and which research bets to fund.
- Leading R&D on next-generation capabilities: image generation, heat-map technology for CLIP-based audiences, upgraded audience modeling, and a new marketing model.
- Redesigned scoring architecture across the platform — hero-image scoring, PDP conversion models, and category benchmark methodology — balancing predictive accuracy with customer actionability.
- Built and manage the data science team: hiring, mentoring, promotion standards, and delivery prioritization across production ML, customer analytics, and research.
- Act as the final scientific check on everything the platform ships, and represent the science directly with enterprise customers — presenting, explaining, and defending methodology as the person accountable for it.
- Evaluated and negotiated technical data partnerships, including validation of third-party market-intelligence data sources against internal ground truth before commercial commitment.

Staff Data Scientist, Ecommerce

Sep 2025 – Mar 2026

Vizit · Boston, MA

- Built the Sales Intelligence / Competitive Insights dashboard that became the default pre-sales workflow, influencing **$250K–$800K in revenue pipeline**.
- Scaled causal-inference impact studies for the world's largest consumer brands — from experiment design (difference-in-differences) through presenting results to the customer: **60 studies delivered, $186K in cost savings, 5,000+ analyst hours automated** via self-serve dashboards.

- Delivered churn-prevention analytics that protected **~$500K in total contract value across 9 at-risk enterprise accounts**.
- Scaled Competitive Intelligence Report (CIR) generation and validated new models for how product imagery performs on the digital shelf across Amazon and Walmart.

Senior Ecommerce Data Scientist
Apr 2025 – Sep 2025

Vizit · Boston, MA

- Worked across R&D and client-facing data science: model validation for digital-shelf image performance, category benchmark methodology, and customer-facing analytics for global consumer brands.

Senior Data Scientist
Dec 2021 – Apr 2025

Northwestern Mutual · Boston, MA

- Built and deployed production ML across the disability claims business. Flagship: an XGBoost straight-through-processing pipeline that cut claim decision time by **75% (~42 days)**.
- Reconfigured an LLM to extract medical terminology from handwritten claim forms, lifting model precision by 20%.
- Invented a generative-AI oversampling method that cut noise by 90% versus KNN-SMOTE; shipped it as an internal Python package used across teams.
- Built a churn-prediction model for financial representatives driving **$15M+ in annual savings**.
- Line-managed a team of junior analysts and data scientists; specialized in translating model metrics into business outcomes so models actually got adopted.

Data Scientist
Aug 2019 – Dec 2021

Harley-Davidson Motor Company · Milwaukee, WI

- First data scientist hired at Harley-Davidson — built the data science function from zero; by departure, led a team of data scientists and analysts reporting insights directly to executives.
- Built the prospect-identification model behind precision marketing (90% accuracy), generating **$35M in annualized revenue**.
- Partnered with product and marketing to identify which customer interactions drive purchases, lifting conversion by **44%**.
- Built an NLP pipeline over customer reviews that turned rider sentiment into a per-bike desirability metric; desirability, lifetime value, sentiment, lead, and retention scores became standard company-wide metrics.

Data Scientist (Intern → Data Scientist)
Mar 2018 – Jun 2019

University of Oklahoma · Oklahoma City / Norman, OK

- Developed a Computer-Aided Detection (CAD) model classifying suspicious breast masses on full-field digital mammograms as benign or malignant — full pipeline from preprocessing and feature selection through cross-validation, tuning, and interpretability. Graduate TA for Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining.
- As intern, built Python data pipelines and classification models for gray-market device detection that were incorporated into production products.

Java Developer
Jun 2016 – Jul 2017

Pyro Group · Hyderabad, India

- Developed dynamic web applications using agile scrum; awarded “Best Employee” for design and development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

ML & AI: Causal Inference (DiD), A/B Testing & Experiment Design, XGBoost, Deep Learning, Computer Vision (CLIP, EfficientNet), LLMs & Generative AI, NLP, GAMs, Oversampling & Imbalanced Learning, Recommendation & Scoring Systems

Engineering: Python, SQL, Production ML Pipelines, ONNX, AWS (S3), Snowflake, Model Deployment & Monitoring, Internal Package Development

Leadership: AI Strategy & Governance, Org Design & Team Building, Executive Communication, Customer-Facing Science, Cross-Functional Delivery (Product, Engineering, Sales, CS)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Computer Science — University of Oklahoma
B.Tech Computer Science — Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University
Certifications: Machine Learning · Generative AI for Executives **Languages:** English · Hindi · Telugu (Native)